

Type of Intervention: Small Group

Domain: Socioemotional

Student/Adult Name (if applicable): Pope Pals

Number of Students (if applicable): 6

Grade of student(s) being worked with or discussed: 3rd-5th boys

What was the reason for the intervention?

The counselor completed a needs assessment, where students were identified for this group based on recorded behavioral issues at school (number of write-ups, disciplined by administration, and teacher referrals). Six boys, grades 3rd - 5th, were identified as those who would potentially benefit from the mentor small group.

Provide a brief summary of the intervention:

The students met once a week after school with a group of mentors, high school senior boys from Pope High School. The group ran from 2:10 pm - 3:30 pm on Wednesday afternoons in the spring semester. The small group meetings were facilitated by the co-counselors and the counseling intern. The meetings began with snacks and games (Uno, Jenga, etc.) until the high school mentors arrived at the elementary school. Following their arrival, an activity was facilitated to encourage working together and mentorship between the elementary students and the mentors. An example of an activity that they participated in is an adventure therapy activity, where the students and mentors had to work as a team to help each individual cross a pattern on the floor that they did not know beforehand, without speaking. They had to use listening skills and nonverbal communication skills to get each person across the floor as quickly as possible without making any mistakes. The small group meetings usually ended with time spent outside, where the mentors and students played basketball, football, or kickball as a group.

Describe what went well:

The activities that were facilitated encouraged the students and the mentors to work together to solve puzzles, answer questions, and complete tasks. The students were able to work on their problem-solving skills and their communication skills with each other and their mentors. The mentors were also able to model positive behaviors, especially during activities when an issue was encountered (if they didn't get the answer right, they were able to demonstrate effective responses without yelling or having an outburst). The counselors also did an effective job preparing the students for the final meeting, notifying them weeks in advance when the conclusion was and discussing feelings around the group's closure.

Describe what you would like to work on after reflecting on this intervention:

Some of the mentors were inconsistent in showing up for meetings, with only 4 high schoolers consistently showing up each week. I would like to have a formal schedule and commitment guidelines so that they understand the importance of showing up and participating each week. I would also possibly assign each child to one mentor, encouraging more connection and one-on-one time between the pairs.

What is your plan for follow-up with the student(s), family member, or staff member?

I would collect data to see if there has been any improvement in behavior referrals and issues since the beginning of the small group. I would also interview teachers and administration to get their input on any changes they have observed in the students. Unofficial qualitative data was collected by speaking to the students following the final meeting, where they were given the opportunity to state their feelings about the group. I would follow this up with giving the students a written post-test to determine if they found the group effective for them.